

such events along with data useful for subsequent analysis. These logs and events can be found in the System Log using Event Viewer.

10.6.4 Increasing Automation

Through the Task Scheduler, Windows Vista greatly increases the administrator's ability to automate tasks. Task Scheduler is much more powerful in Windows Vista than in earlier versions of Windows. It can still be used to launch tasks at specific times or when the computer starts up. Under Vista though, the scheduler can be used to trigger tasks or programs when events occur. Thus if the Windows Diagnostics services detect that a drive has insufficient space, an admin can set up the system to track for the event and either send across a notification to the support desk, or to automatically resolve the issue.

Similarly, an admin can use the Task Scheduler to start disk defragmentation or perhaps a data backup when the computer is detected as idle. Programs can also be launched automatically upon locking or unlocking of a computer workstation. Tasks can also be queued under the Scheduler.

10.6.5 Automatic Recovery

Windows Vista automatically recovers from many types of failures, including failed services and corrupted system files. Every service has a recovery policy, so if it fails, Windows Vista may be able to restart it automatically. Windows Vista includes the Startup Repair Tool (SRT) to automatically fix common problems with startup. On boot failure, the system kicks into the SRT which automatically diagnoses the problem and tries to determine the cause of startup failure. If SRT is unable to resolve the issue, the system is rolled back to the last known working state.

The repair tool is also located in Vista's install DVD. To start the tool from there, insert the DVD, restart your machine, and boot into the Vista DVD. You need to now choose View System Recovery Options (Advanced) from the menu and then select Startup Repair from the list of recovery tools.